

Actionability Next Steps Memo

Short planning memo following the `actionability_algebra_v1/v2/v3` sequence.

DECISION

Push one harder synthetic step, then bridge only the surviving claim back to real DX data.

Situation

After v3, the synthetic program has a split result:

- the early market-preference result is robust enough to keep
- the clean downstream permission result is not yet robust enough to headline

That means the synthetic line is still worth continuing, but only in a way that increases semantic pressure and reduces surface-form shortcutting.

Recommended v4

The best immediate synthetic experiment is `actionability_algebra_v4`.

Core changes:

- Keep the v3 paraphrases.
- Keep shuffled bullet order within sections.
- Add distractor numeric lines to both `## PORTFOLIO CONTEXT` and `## EXECUTION CONSTRAINTS`.
- Increase scenario-group diversity so held-out splits are less tied to a single phrasing template.
- Rewrite local permission cues in multiple equivalent ways.

Target question:

Can any downstream permission or actionability read survive once the permission-relevant numbers and phrases are no longer uniquely salient?

Success Criteria

v4 would count as genuinely interesting if all three hold:

- `market_best_asset` stays near ceiling in row states

- at least one downstream permission-side classifier stays materially above chance under held-out scenario groups
- the best downstream section remains stable across prompt variants instead of migrating arbitrarily with phrasing changes

If those fail, the cleaner research story becomes:

- market preference is early and robust
- permission is weaker, distributed, and presentation-sensitive

Real-Data Bridge

Only bridge the strongest surviving claim:

1. Validate early preference on real DX prompts.
2. Test permission as a noisy downstream gating signal, not as a crisp semantic classifier.
3. Prefer paired reruns and controlled perturbations over generic observe-class probing.

What To Deprioritize

- Do not over-invest in a pure “permission manifold” story yet.
- Do not treat v2 alone as sufficient evidence.
- Do not expand into large real-data capture for permission until the synthetic side survives v4.

Why This Is Still Good Progress

v3 is not a failure. It did exactly what a robustness phase should do: it showed which part of the v2 story survives and which part does not.

That is a better research position than having only the convenient v2 result.